

ENGLISH LANGUAGE PAPER 4**PART A Group Interaction**

Below is an extract from a newspaper article about a study tour:

Extreme Study Tour: Antarctica

From December 2013 to January 2014, City University of Hong Kong sent a team of 23 undergraduates on a 3-week research expedition to Antarctica. Antarctica is one of the planet's loneliest, coldest, most fragile and endangered landscapes. At its centre is the South Pole. The students – who are from different departments – collected environmental and ecological data to turn into creative art forms.



“The Antarctica expedition enables creative artists, researchers and scientists to work together, interpreting environmental data into interesting visuals such as animation, gaming and film,” said team leader Prof. Scott Hessels. “This once-in-a-lifetime trip will offer new insights into a sustainable future and help the public better understand environment issues.”

Some activities that students did in Antarctica included tracking and measuring changes in the body temperature of penguins; studying life in Antarctica; examining physical properties of icebergs; and collecting sound recordings of Antarctic winds.

Students had to prepare themselves physically and take first-aid courses, as well as obtain all necessary equipment. Another challenge was to raise HK\$30,000 funding per person, which was 40% of the full cost per person, with university and external sponsorships covering the rest of the expenses.

As the Student Committee of your school's upcoming overseas study tour, your group is meeting to discuss the possibility of going to Antarctica. You may want to talk about:

- whether Antarctica would be a suitable location
- what difficulties students could face if they went to Antarctica
- how to choose students to join the study tour
- anything else you think is important

PART B Individual Response

1. Do you like study tours?
2. Would you enjoy travelling overseas with your classmates?
3. How would you feel if you were away from your family for three weeks?
4. What would your parents say if you wanted to go to Antarctica?
5. Would you want to go to Antarctica if funding was available?
6. Would you prefer a school tour that was educational or entertaining?
7. Should schools organize study tours to remote locations?
8. How would a study tour to Antarctica be beneficial to Hong Kong?